

Zenith Admirale

The Value Laptop For Office

Zenith has launched three affordable laptops for entry-level consumers and students: Admirale, Director and Presidio. The cost cutting is evident from the start—this Santa Rosa laptop has a low-powered Intel T2310 processor running at 1460 MHz. The 2 GB of RAM is a pleasant surprise in an entry-level laptop. The lustrous grey body looks good and is rugged; even the hinges seem strong and the single latch on the lid allows you to open it with one hand.

The 14.1-inch display is one of the dimmest TFTs we have seen. Forget outdoors, you may have difficulty viewing it indoors if the room is brightly lit.

The keypad is spacious and comfortable, and the keys offer good feedback. The touchpad is good too, and we have no complaints. Movie playback is good, and the speakers produce

clear sound, though not particularly loud. The dim TFT subtracts from the movie experience obviously. TV-out and D-Sub ports will let you show your presentations on bigger screens.

It's obvious that the laptop is aimed at the office segment, and it does well in this regard. The batteries lasted for 2 hours 43 minutes in our battery drain test, which is pretty good. It should last a lot longer if office applications are all that you will use.

Windows Vista Starter Edition is the OS loaded, and it runs well thanks to the 2 GB of RAM. If needed,

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★●
Performance	★★★★●
Build quality	★★★★●
Value for Money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●



you can easily upgrade to a more powerful version of Vista. An integrated Web cam would have been a worthwhile and inexpensive value-add, and could have found use for office applications such as video conferencing.

At just Rs 27,990, this laptop strikes the right balance between price, performance and portability, and we recommend it for office work. If you look hard enough, though, you could find better bargains.

Specifications

Intel T2310 Dual Core processor- 1460 MHz, 533 MHz FSB; 2 GB 667 MHz DDR2 RAM @533 MHz; 120 GB hard drive; DVD Writer; 14.1-inch WXGA monitor, Resolution: 1280x800; Connectivity: Gigabit LAN, 56 Kbps Modem, WiFi 802.11g; SD memory slot; Bundled OS: Windows Vista Starter Edition

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Price: Rs 27,990

Transcend T.photo 710

The Photo Frame Just Went Digital

Transcend's T.photo 710 is a 1 GB photo frame that looks like any other photo frame, but there's more to it.

The T.photo 710 is a fairly stylish looking frame, with a design that's not too modern or too classic. The 7-inch TFT display is surrounded by a transparent border with an accented outline. It must be said that the frame itself is quite large. You can hang it on a wall or place it on a table or shelf.

There is 1 GB of onboard memory, and you can also use SD, MMC, Memory Stick, CompactFlash or even USB Flash drives, so there's no real limit to how much media you can use on it. You can also connect your PC to the photo frame and directly dump your media

on to it like you would with any other drive. It's not just photos that you can use the T.photo 710 for—it can also be your music player. It has inbuilt speakers for that, as well as a headphone jack, should you want to connect headphones or your speakers to it.

The interface is colourful, and using the frame is simple as today's PMPs. The remote control works fine up to a distance of 10-12ft. The transition from one image to the other isn't as reactive as you'd want it to be espe-

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cially when you're using manual controls on the remote to browse through large JPEG images taken on your camera for example. The quality of the screen also is pretty good with wide viewing angles.

There's one issue with the photo frame though—there's a thick power cable that ruins its elegance—a battery powered, thinner frame and a larger screen. At Rs 6,000, the price seems just right, considering you

have a remote controlled photo frame that's also your music player and your alarm clock.

Specifications

7-inch TFT screen, 1GB internal memory, D/SDHC/MMC/MS/CF Cards/USB Flash drives supported

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Price: Rs 6,000